Incident report: 3-D Secure challenge failures for Visa cards

Document: INC-303

Date: 2026-03-27

Services: card-gateway

Summary

A SEV2 incident affected 3-D Secure challenge processing for Visa cards on March 26, 2026. The card-gateway service experienced failures between 09:12 and 11:03 UTC. Investigation confirmed a fault on the NorthBank side. NorthBank identified and resolved the issue. CHG-1055 was investigated as a potential cause and ruled out; CHG-1055 was not rolled back.

Impact

Approximately 2.3% of card payments were affected during the incident window. These payments required 3-D Secure verification for Visa cards but encountered failures in the challenge process. Merchants experienced payment declines for affected transactions. The incident was classified as SEV2 due to the scope of payment processing disruption.

Timeline

- 09:12 UTC: Elevated error rates detected in 3-D Secure challenge responses for Visa cards

- 09:45 UTC: Incident declared; card-gateway team engaged

- 10:15 UTC: Investigation began into CHG-1055, deployed the previous day

- 10:40 UTC: NorthBank contacted; preliminary investigation indicated fault on NorthBank side

- 11:03 UTC: NorthBank confirmed resolution of their fault; error rates returned to normal

- 11:30 UTC: All-clear confirmed; incident closed

Root Cause

NorthBank confirmed a fault on the NorthBank side affecting 3-D Secure verification processing. The fault was not related to recent changes in card-gateway. CHG-1055 was investigated and ruled out as a contributing factor.

Resolution

NorthBank resolved the fault on their infrastructure. No changes to card-gateway were required. The service recovered automatically once NorthBank's systems returned to normal operation.

Follow-up Actions

- Review incident response procedures with reference to RB-05

- Coordinate with NorthBank on advance notification protocols for their maintenance windows

- Document lessons learned in STS-303